MIL-B-43255A

20 March 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43255
31 August 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAG, PLASTIC, ENTOMOLOGICAL SPECIMENS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two sizes of plastic entomological specimen bags.

1.2 Classification. The plastic bags shall be of the following overall sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Size I - 6 inches wide, 12 inches long.
Size II - 12 inches wide, 16 inches long.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing.

FSC 8105

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MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US Postal Service Manual

(Copies of the manual may be obtained from the Superintendant of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Freight Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The bag shall be fabricated from natural color polyethylene tubing, 0.002 inch nominal thickness conforming to type I, class 1, finish 1 of L-P-378, except that the properties concerning slip shall not apply.

3.2 Design and construction. The bag shall be constructed from one piece of material specified in 3.1 and shall be rectangular in shape. One end of the bag shall be heat sealed in such a manner as to provide a seal breaking strength of not less than 60 percent of the breaking strength of the polyethylene film (see 4.3.2). The seal shall be perpendicular to the sides of the

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tubing; shall be continuous, and shall be from 1/8 to 1/4 inch in width. The excess film between the bottom edge of the tubing and the bottom edge of the heat seal shall not exceed 1/4 inch.

3.2.1 Bag leakage. The bag shall not leak when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.3 Dimensions.

3.3.1 Size I. The overall dimensions of the size I bag shall be 12 ± 1/4 inches long by 6 ± 1/4 inches in width.

3.3.2 Size II. The overall dimensions of the size II bag shall be 16 ± 1/4 inches long by 12 ± 1/4 inches in width.

* 3.4 Workmanship. The bags shall be clean, and shall be free from any crack, cut, tear, crease, wrinkle, hole (including pinhole), or extraneous matter which might impair their usefulness. All sealed edges shall be uniform in width and all peripheral edges shall be neatly and cleanly cut.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for examination and tests shall consist of all material submitted for inspection at one time.

* 4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

* 4.3.1 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with 4.3.1.1 thru 4.3.1.4. The applicable inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL) shall be as specified in 4.3.1.5. The lot for purposes of examination in tables I and II shall be expressed as units of bags, envelopes of bags, or shipping containers as applicable.

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* 4.3.1.1 Examination of the end item for defects in construction, appearance, material and workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bag. Not more than 10 sample units shall be drawn from any one envelope of bags nor shall more than 2 interior packages be selected from any one shipping container for sampling.

TABLE I. Examination for defects

Examine	Defect
Construction and appearance	Not design specified Not formed from one tube of film with single seam Seam not uniform, continuous or adequate Seam edge not perpendicular to sides of bag
Material	Any blister or fish eye, or unfused resin particle Not fabricated from material specified Material not uniform natural color
Workmanship	Any hole, pinhole, crack, wrinkle, tear, sharp, crease, cut, gel defect 1/ Any spot, stain or other discoloration Not clean, evidence of dirt, grit, oil or other foreign matter on or in bag

1/ Sporadic gel defects or unfused resin particles no larger than 1/32 inch in diameter, unless occurring in seam will be acceptable.

4.3.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bag.

Examine	Defect
Overall dimensions	Not within specified tolerances (see 3.3.1 or 3.3.2, as applicable)
Heat seal seam	Less than 1/8 inch wide More than 1/4 inch wide Excess film between bottom edge of seam and bottom of tubing more than 1/4 inch

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4.3.1.3 Examination of the end item for count. The sample unit for this examination shall be one interior package (envelope) of bags. The average count per package shall not be less than the specified quantity.

* 4.3.1.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery except that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery requirements

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted containers
Content	Number of interior packages per shipping container is more or less than required

* 4.3.1.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). The inspection levels for determining the sample size and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL
4.3.1.1	II	2.5
4.3.1.2	S-3	6.5
4.3.1.3	S-2	---
4.3.1.4	S-2	4.0

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* 4.3.2 Testing of the end item. Testing shall be performed for the applicable characteristics indicated in table II on samples randomly selected from each lot of bags offered for Government acceptance. The sample unit shall be one bag for each test indicated in table III. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL expressed in defects per hundred units shall be 4.0 for each test.

TABLE III. Instructions for testing end item

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Number of tests per sample unit	Results reported as pass or fail
Heat seal strength	3.2	4.4.2	2 1/	X
Bag leakage	3.2.1	4.4.3	1	X

1/ Any failure shall constitute a defect.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Test conditions. All physical tests shall be performed in accordance with standard conditions as defined in FED-STD-406.

* 4.4.2 Heat seal strength. The breaking strength of the heat seal shall be determined in accordance with procedure method B of test method 1013 of FED-STD-406. The width of the specimen shall be not more than one inch, the initial jaw separation shall be two inches plus or minus 1/16 inch and the seam shall be parallel to the jaws as well as equidistant plus or minus 1/16 inch between the two jaws. Failure of any sample to comply with the requirements of 3.2 shall be recorded as a defect.

* 4.4.3 Bag leakage. The bag shall be filled to 2 inches above the bottom seam with water containing sufficient dye to produce a distinct color. The bag shall be suspended for one hour at room temperature and then visually examined for leakage. Any leakage shall constitute failure of the test (see 3.2.1).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred bags of one size only shall be neatly and evenly stacked and then packaged in a snug-fitting end opening paper envelope. The envelope shall be fabricated from minimum substance 28 brown kraft paper and secured with a clasp or string and button closure.

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* 5.1.2 Level C (commercial packaging). Bags shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supplier to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A. Bags of one size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed flat in the quantities and arrangements specified in table IV within a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

TABLE IV. Quantity of bags and packing arrangement of level A packages within a shipping container

Size of bags (inches)	Quantity of bags per shipping container (each)	Packing arrangement of level A packages
Size I (6 x 12)	6,000	2 L x 1 W x 30D
Size II (12 x 16)	2,000	1 L x 1 W x 20D

* 5.2.2 Level B. Bags of one size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed flat in the quantities and arrangements specified in table IV within a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

* 5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

* 5.2.3 Level C (commercial packing). Bags, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the US Postal Service Manual, Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

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5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The polyethylene bags are used as a container for rodents, rodent parasites and other entomological specimens in field preventive medicine procedures.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
Bag, Plastic, Entomological Specimens MIL-B-43255A

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

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   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

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